❸ The content in the Razor view to render inside the layout

Any contents in the view are be rendered inside the layout, where the call to `@RenderBody()` occurs. Combining the two previous listings generates the following HTML.

Listing 17.9 Rendered output from combining a view with its layout

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
    <meta charset="utf-8" />
    <title>Home Page</title>          ❶
    <link rel="stylesheet" href="/css/site.css" />
</head>
<body>
    <h1>Home Page</h1>                ❷
    <p>This is the home page</p>      ❷
</body>
<html>
```

❶ ViewData set in the view is used to render the layout.

❷ The RenderBody call renders the contents of the view.

Judicious use of layouts can be extremely useful in reducing the duplication between pages. By default, layouts provide only a single location where you can render content from the view, at the call to `@RenderBody`. In cases where this is too restrictive, you can render content using *sections*.

17.4.2 Overriding parent layouts using sections

A common requirement when you start using multiple layouts in your application is to be able to render content from child views in more than one place in your layout. Consider the case of a layout that uses two columns. The view needs a mechanism for saying “render *this* content in the *left* column” and “render this *other* content in the *right* column.” This is achieved using *sections*.